

adopted in anti-Maoist operations elsewhere in the country. Notwithstanding odd charges of favouritism and of condoning political violence in his native Kadapa, YSR has left the stage with a near impeccable record.

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

At a time when even Sonia Gandhi and Prime Minister Manmohan Singh were not sure of a victory in Andhra Pradesh, Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy waved his magic wand with an incurable optimism to decorate the pedestal of the Congress party with a resounding victory. There can never be a second opinion that the sudden demise of YSR has left not only his family but also the state Congress orphaned.

T.S. FERNANDO,

Virugambakkam, Chennai

Fair Play

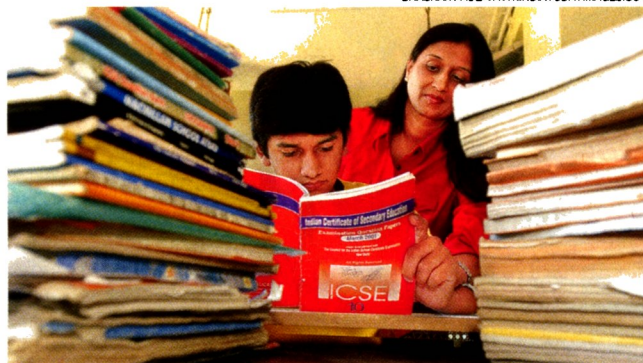
Our domestic football teams like East Bengal and Mohun Bagan need to import talent from African countries to create hype and draw crowds to the matches ("Captain Marvel", September 14). A sport like cricket gets all the money and facilities, even though it is not an Olympic sport. Football, tennis, shooting, athletics and swimming are Olympic disciplines where India needs to concentrate. One can only hope that the sports ministry

realises that these sporting disciplines need its support to develop and prosper in this cricket-crazed nation.

M.K. LAL, *Gurgaon*

Defending India

I would like to thank INDIA TODAY for bringing to light the deficiencies in our defence preparedness ("No Defence", September 14). The country needs more anti-aircraft guns to handle various kinds of at-



“ Rather than doing away with the yearly Board examination, the CBSE should introduce trimester exams. This will ensure that students study throughout the year. ”

GROUP CAPT S.P. CHATURVEDI, *Delhi*

tacks. However, with the contract being stalled and no other global company except Germany's Rheinmetall coming forward, the Defence Ministry should get involved in finalising the deal instead of banking on the Ordnance Factory Board.

RANJIT SINHA,

via www.indiatoday.in

Law for All

Questions have been raised about the disproportionate assets of judges time and again ("Judiciary Under Scrutiny", September 7). With the present chief justice of India (CJI) as well as former CJIs having admitted to corruption, favouritism and other malpractices, declaring assets would only restore the credibility of the judiciary.

A. SRIKANTIAH,
via www.indiatoday.in

BHASKAR PAUL / WWW.INDIATODAYIMAGES.COM

Politics of Division

Talking of India's Partition is a colossal waste of time and energy ("Who Partitioned India?", August 31). We may not admit it but it is a natural urge of a group of people of a particular religion or language to secure power and rule that leads to such events.

B.H. AGARWAL, *Bhopal*

30
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NOVEMBER 16-30, 1979

A Troubled Marriage

They are the oddest couple in the country. What can, after all, a querulous 77-year-old leader of the Jats see in a tubby, urbane Congressman who was once declared Mr Mysore in a body-building contest? Apparently very little. But the case of the curious alliance between Chaudhary Charan Singh and Devraj Urs is nothing but a marriage of convenience. Ever since the two came together like lovers on a rebound late in August, there has been trouble in the air. It is not merely that a cantankerous but shrewish mother-in-law like Raj Narain plagues their relationship. The major cause of marital disharmony are the alliance leaders themselves, their conflicting ideologies and shifting loyalties, their regional power-bases and separate votebanks. Just over three years ago, Charan Singh was a name few had heard in New Delhi.

by Sunil Sethi and Prabhu Chawla



CHARAN SINGH AND DEVRAJ URS

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